



AMC STANDARD PATHWAY

For International Medical Graduates

A step-by-step guide from medical school to medical registration in Australia

BEYOND MEDICAL SCHOOL

The AMC Pathway in a Glance



Introduction

The Australian Medical Council (AMC) Standard Pathway is designed for International Medical Graduates (IMGs) seeking general registration as medical practitioners in Australia who are not eligible for the Competent Authority Pathway.

The pathway involves:

- AMC CAT MCQ examination
- AMC Clinical Examination OR AMC-accredited Workplace-Based Assessment (WBA)

1. Medical School Graduate

You must have an eligible Primary Medical Qualification (PMQ) — your final medical degree/diploma in medicine and surgery.

2. Confirm Medical School & Qualification Eligibility

Before starting, confirm that:

- Your medical school is recognised by the AMC.
- Your medical qualification is eligible.
- Your medical school is listed in the World Directory of Medical Schools (WDOMS).

The AMC provides an eligibility-checking process for the overseas medical school, degree title and graduation year.

3. Create a MyIntealth Account

Create a MyIntealth Applicant Portal account.

Approximate current fee: US\$110.

You will generally need:

- Personal information
- Medical school information
- Current, unexpired passport
- Recent digital photograph

Complete the Intealth Identification Form (IIF) and receive a MyIntealth ID.

4. Establish an EPIC Portfolio

Through MyIntealth/EPIC:

- Request establishment of an EPIC Portfolio.
- Select the Australian Medical Council (AMC) as the organisation receiving the verification.

EPIC Portfolio establishment fee: US\$35.

You will receive an EPIC ID.

5. Primary Source Verification (PSV)

Your medical qualification must undergo Primary Source Verification.

The credential is verified directly with the issuing medical school/institution.

Important:

- Contact your medical school's Dean's/Academic/Registrar's office early.
- The medical school may charge its own administrative fee.
- Verification can take time, so start early.

ECFMG/Intealth performs PSV through EPIC, with verification information provided to the AMC.

6. Create an AMC Account & Establish Your AMC Portfolio

Create an account with the Australian Medical Council and establish your AMC portfolio.

You will provide your EPIC ID and submit your qualification for verification.

Current AMC fees:

- Initial portfolio + first qualification: AUD \$642
- Additional qualification: AUD \$107 each

7. Apply for AMC CAT MCQ Authorisation

Apply through your AMC account for authorisation to sit the AMC Computer Adaptive Test (CAT) Multiple Choice Question (MCQ) Examination.

Current fee: AUD \$2,920.

Authorisation is valid for 12 months, during which you must schedule and sit an AMC CAT MCQ examination event.

8. Schedule the AMC CAT MCQ Examination

Once authorised:

- Schedule your examination through Pearson VUE.
- Pearson VUE provides examination venues and handles scheduling.

Examinations are conducted in Australia and at selected international Pearson VUE centres. Locations can change.

Usual locations may include South Africa, the United Kingdom and India.

Ghanaian candidates should check the current AMC/Pearson VUE venue list before making travel arrangements.

9. AMC CAT MCQ Examination

FORMAT

- 150 MCQs
- Approximately 3.5 hours
- One correct answer from five options
- Computer-administered
- Delivered through Pearson VUE

ASSESSES

Knowledge relevant to safe medical practice in Australia, including:

- General practice
- Internal medicine
- Paediatrics
- Psychiatry
- Surgery
- Obstetrics & gynaecology

PASS STANDARD

Results are reported on a 0–500 scale, with the pass standard described as 250.

PREPARATION RESOURCES

- Murtagh's General Practice
- UpToDate
- AMBOSS
- AMC Handbook/Examination Specifications
- AMC official MCQ Preparation App
- AMEDEX
- MPlusX
- Other AMC-focused question banks

The AMC also provides a free MCQ preparation resource with practice questions.

10. English Language Proficiency

You must meet the Medical Board of Australia's English Language Skills Registration Standard.

IELTS Academic:

- Overall: 7.0
- Listening: 7.0
- Reading: 7.0
- Speaking: 7.0
- Writing: 6.5

PTE Academic:

- Overall: 65
- Listening: 65
- Reading: 65
- Writing: 65
- Speaking: 65

Check the current Medical Board standard at the time of application because requirements can change.

English requirements are a registration requirement, not an AMC examination requirement itself.

11. Registration & Employment After Passing the MCQ

Passing the AMC CAT MCQ does not by itself give you general registration.

Depending on your circumstances, you may be able to obtain limited registration for supervised practice/postgraduate training or area-of-need employment.

At this stage, candidates may apply for suitable supervised medical positions.

Employment opportunities may be affected by:

- Clinical experience
- Recency of practice
- Australian clinical experience
- References
- Willingness to work in rural/regional areas
- Availability of suitable supervised positions
- Employer requirements

Passing the AMC MCQ does not guarantee employment.

12. Complete the AMC Clinical Examination OR WBA

OPTION A — AMC CLINICAL EXAMINATION

Assesses: Medicine, Surgery, Obstetrics & gynaecology, Paediatrics. Psychiatry and Communication with patients, families and healthcare professionals

Current format:

- 16 assessed stations
- 2 pilot stations
- 14 stations determine the final result
- 10 minutes per station: 2 minutes reading + 8 minutes assessment

Pass requirement: 9 or more of the 14 scored stations.

Current fees:

- In-person: AUD \$3,000
- Online: AUD \$3,400
- Online availability is limited.

12. Option B — AMC-Accredited Workplace-Based Assessment (WBA)

WBA is an alternative to the AMC Clinical Examination.

It assesses clinical knowledge and performance in the workplace, generally over 6–12 months.

To enter a WBA program, you must:

- Have passed the AMC CAT MCQ.
- Have appropriate registration with the Medical Board of Australia.
- Hold an appointed position in an approved hospital or general practice setting.
- Meet the individual WBA provider's eligibility requirements.

AMC-listed WBA fee: AUD \$1,070. Individual providers may have additional costs.

13. Obtain the AMC Certificate

The AMC can issue your AMC Certificate once you have:

- Completed primary source verification
- Passed the AMC CAT MCQ
- Passed the AMC Clinical Examination OR completed an approved WBA

The AMC Certificate enables you to apply for registration with the Medical Board of Australia.

14. Apply for Registration Through AHPRA

Apply to the Medical Board of Australia through AHPRA (Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency).

The Board assesses requirements including:

- English language skills
- Recency of practice
- Criminal history
- Professional indemnity insurance
- Continuing professional development
- Proof of identity
- Supervised practice requirements

15. Provisional Registration & Supervised Practice

AMC Certificate ≠ immediate general registration.

AMC Certificate holders generally need to obtain provisional registration and complete the required approved supervised practice in Australia.

Current requirement: 12 months / 47 weeks full-time equivalent of approved supervised practice for AMC Certificate holders seeking general registration.

Some IMGs may undertake part or all of the supervised practice while holding limited registration.

16. General Registration

After satisfactorily completing the required supervised practice and meeting the Board's other registration standards, you can apply for general registration with the Medical Board of Australia.

Current requirement: evidence of satisfactory completion of 12 months / 47 weeks FTE approved supervised practice, together with other applicable registration requirements.

17. Obtain a Principal HO / RMO Position

After obtaining the General registration, you can apply for the following jobs based on your working experience:

- Resident Medical Officer (RMO)
- Principal House Officer (PHO)

18. Specialist Training

Once you have established yourself within the Australian medical system and meet the relevant requirements, you can apply for entry into specialist training.

Examples of specialist colleges:

- Royal Australasian College of Physicians (RACP)
- Royal Australasian College of Surgeons (RACS)
- Royal Australian and New Zealand College of Obstetricians and Gynaecologists (RANZCOG)
- Australian College of Emergency Medicine (ACEM)
- Other recognised specialist colleges

Entry requirements vary by specialty and training program.

AMC STANDARD PATHWAY — KEY TAKEAWAY

- **Understand the pathway:** Know the exams, registration requirements, timeline and overall process before starting.
- **Plan financially:** The pathway is capital intensive, so ensure you are genuinely committed to pursuing it.
- **Prepare strategically:** Build a strong foundation and use practice questions and assessments to track your readiness.
- **Think beyond the exams:** Passing the AMC exams does not guarantee employment or specialist training.
- **Research employment early:** Be open to different locations, specialties and entry-level opportunities.
- **Plan long-term:** Consider your goals for registration, training and eventual specialization.
- **Stay updated:** Requirements can change, so always check the AMC and Medical Board of Australia/Ahpra for current information.

NB: All fees stated are subject to change. Visit “Australian Medical Council — Fees and Charges” for the updated fees